community was not entirely pleased to be confronted with the Cuba that had evolved over two decades of revolution, superimposed onto the Cuba they remembered, and had worked so hard to recreate in Miami. “The established Cuban exile community simply disapproved of the race, ideology, values, and culture of the new exiles, many of whom had grown up with the revolution.”[12] Asked whether they experienced discrimination in the United States, 30 percent of those surveyed from the Mariel boatlift believed that Anglos discriminated against them – while 80 percent believed that older-established Cubans did![13]

Most Latin American immigrants in the United States maintain close ties to their homelands, especially in the first generation. These ties include frequent travel back and forth, phone calls, remittances and, towards the end of the twentieth century, videos and internet communications. The hostile relationship between Cuba and the United States meant that these kinds of communications have been much more difficult, and have been subject to arbitrary government policies. Frequently, the decision to leave Cuba for the United States has led to years or even decades of broken family ties. Cuban immigrants created a new version of their old Cuba, in Miami, while Cuba itself was changing rapidly.

American film-maker Estela Bravo, who has lived for many years in Cuba, investigated the impact of the political hostilities on families in her documentary *Miami-Havana*. What she found, on both sides of the border, were family members devastated by the years of separation, and longing to be able to visit.

The film also illustrated the generational split among Cubans in the United States that many studies have commented upon. Older Cubans clung to what Portes and Stepick call the “moral community” of their Miami culture: “To be a Miami Cuban, it does not suffice to have escaped from the island; one must also espouse points of view repeated ceaselessly by editorialists in Miami’s Spanish radio and press” – a “ferocious right-wing frame” that put Miami’s Cubans well beyond the mainstream of U.S. politics.[14]